Project B

CS 150 with Dr. Sam Schwartz

Due: Friday, November 6 during class (Interview)
Sunday, November 8 at 11:59pm via Canvas Upload (Reports)

Purpose

The purpose of this assignment is to help you prepare for obtaining a computing-related job or internship. You will reflect on your career goals, learn from professionals in the field, analyze real job postings, design an interview process, and practice interviewing skills. This project is intended to bridge the gap between your academic experience and the expectations of employers in the computing industry.

Tasks

Part A: Career Plan (20 points)

Write a **one-page** plan describing how you will obtain your next tech/computing-related job or internship. Your plan should include:

- Types of roles you are targeting
- Companies or organizations of interest
- Skills you currently have and skills you need to develop
- Concrete steps you will take over the next 3–6 months
- Specific people / websites / resources that you will use to find a job you love.

Be specific and actionable. If you already have a job/internship lined up, pretend that tomorrow you get a call or email from that employer saying the job no longer exists. What's your plan B?

Part B: Informational Interview (25 points)

Conduct an informational interview with a computing professional in a role or organization you are interested in (even if they are not hiring).

What is an informational interview? An informational interview is a conversation with a professional to learn about their career path, role, organization, and advice for entering the field. It is not a job interview, but rather an opportunity to gather insight and build connections.

After completing the interview, write a **one-page** report that includes:

- Who you spoke with
- Their title/role
- Their organization
- What you learned (skills, career path, advice, industry insights)
- Who else you could talk with (always be looking to expand your network; as the saying goes, it's not what you know but who you know.)

Part C: Job Posting Analysis (5 points)

Find at least three job or internship postings in computing or technology that interest you.

For each posting, include:

- A screenshot of the job posting.
- Briefly describe required technologies and skills that you'd still need to obtain, if any.
- Briefly describe how you would prepare for an interview for the role.

Consolidate this into **one-page** report.

Part D: Interview Process Design (25 points)

Imagine you are responsible for hiring a college intern or newly graduated computer science student.

Design a **one-page** interview process proposal that includes:

- Structure of the interview process (must be $\sim$ 10-15 minutes per interview)
- The questions you would ask (including technical, behavioral, etc.)
- How you would evaluate candidates / criteria for identifying strong vs. weak candidates

Remember, if the new hire is a dud, your boss will fire you for incompetence.

Part E: Mock Interviews (25 points)

Execute your interview process by conducting mock interviews with classmates during class on Friday, April 10.

You will both interview others using your designed process and participate as a candidate in others' interviews.

Criteria for Success

- Parts A-D are due on Sunday, April 12 at 11:59 PM via Canvas.
- Each part must be submitted as a separate PDF document: A.pdf, B.pdf, C.pdf, D.pdf.
- You must bring Part D as a printed hard copy to class on Friday, April 10.

What I mean by "one-page":

- 8.5" $\times$ 11" paper with 1" margins.
- Single-spaced, with a 10pt, 11pt or 12pt standard font (e.g., Times New Roman).
- At minimum: 3-5 well-developed paragraphs.

As always, professional English should be used throughout.